the knowledge but also in the action of protecting Israel's security. You connected to this world with your entire self, and with every stage of Kokla's successful career your happiness grew.

Today is the seventeenth anniversary of the day that Kokla left us. The two of you, Kokla and Leika, left us seventeen years apart, both after suffering the agony of the hopeless confrontation with that cursed disease.

Kokla, my brother and soulmate, you were a groundbreaking fighter who formulated new combat doctrines, never gave up on pushing the envelope when it came to taking on risks and operations, and produced generations of daring fighters who adopted the slogan "Only the bold win." If only you knew how many of your trainees now hold the highest positions in the Mossad, you would be so happy. The respect that they feel for you as their commander brings them to visit your grave every year on this day in order to pay their respects. Leika, who was dedicated to you until the day she died, continued to be the link between you and those who were under your command. Her frequent meetings with them became a regular ritual, and they regarded her as one of their own.

Our Leika—you and Kokla and Yael and I walked a long, long way together. After Kokla left us we continued to walk as a trio. We did things together; we saw the world together; we raised children and grandchildren together; we laughed, we cried, we fought, we made up, and today we are unveiling your tombstone. Please, when you meet Kokla somewhere in the fields of eternity, tell him that we did our best to look after you. Please also tell him that seventeen years have not dulled the pain and that from now on it is only doubled.

Your memory will forever be with us.

Shlomo Gal (October 2009)

I met Shlomo for the first time when he was serving as the operations director of the "Caesarea" unit (the Mossad's operations unit). By the time I met him, Shlomo carried with him a rich history of achievements, both in his military service (he received the Chief of General Staff's Citation in Qalqilya) and in the unit, first as a combatant and later as an instructor for other combatants, a director of training, and an operations commander, all